

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

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cont. suffering heat and cold: hunger and fatigue: that then His real and awful sacrifices began indeed: that while He taught His Apostles for 3 years with infinite patience He suffered every manner of insult and calumny, every pain of body, every possible anguish of soul. Dispair of course, He could not suffer, but who will doubt that His "Agony in the Garden" was more awful than any despair ever endured by mere creature? Ah -- His agony

Pg. 39 Febr. 1st Fr. On this Rock I build My -- the gates of H. shall not prevail against it." Matt XVI 18 (Triumph of the Church) next page
There is nothing permanent under the sun. ~~Yez~~ all is change. The flowers of the field, the bubbles of the swelling tide, the gushes of the mountain torrent are seen and vanish away. Men and nations have their time and pass away: their treaties too and their promises are made and forgotten. There is one thing, however, that does not pass away. The words of the Lord remain forever, and His promises are eternally infallible, eternally unfailing - in fulfillment. Why then should it be necessary to pray for the triumph of God's Church? When Jesus promises that the gates of H. shall not prevail, shall we be intimidated by the prowlings of Satan? Is God's assurance not enough for us? Do we not know for sure that His Church must triumph? "On this rock I will build my Ch. and the gates of H. --- against it." Is this not plain enough? Besides, as the Holy Ghost assures, "God is not like man that He should lie or as the sons of men that He should deceive." Has He said then and will He not do? Has he promised and will He not fulfill? "Moreover, we have assurance of divine guidance, of divine presence. "I will send you another paraclete who will abide with you forever" ... "who will teach you all truth and bring to your mind whatsoever I will have said to you" and again, "Behold I am with you all days even to the consumation of the world" What then shall we fear? "If God is with us" as St. Paul asks -- "If God is with us, who shall be against us?